

Researching information, finding answers and making contacts are the main reasons people in business log onto the Internet. A blog can aid in this process, resulting in online networking opportunities. Having a business blog can be a good way for your customers to communicate with you, as well as between themselves, and in the process, form new relationships. While this may sound too esoteric, it's happening right now on the WWW.

Blogging is fast, low-cost and offers a highly effective publishing, marketing and content management tool. However, before adding 'blogging' to your marketing mix, you should be sure you're clear why you're blogging and what you want to get out of it. Do you want your customer's views about certain matters? Do you want to encourage communication between customers and your business?

Once these issues have been addressed, you need to find someone to host your blog. This is a straightforward process, and is virtually free.

If you just search for 'blogging' in Google, you could have a tough time choosing!

Although new, the success of blogging has given rise to a new industry; entrepreneurial media companies have introduced 'blog monitoring', where they scour the net to advise brands on how their name is being talked about online, away from the traditional print and broadcast media

*(Refer bibliography for some of the top blogs from around the world).*

The idea behind this emerging service industry is simple. While there were only 130,000 blogs four years ago, today, there are about 10 million. These Web pages can make or break a company's reputation because they provide links to each other and allow people to comment on postings—in other words, the blog is a huge image-making network that cannot be ignored. Even if you, as a company are ignoring it, others that may be using your products or services